

which peaked at 133 Megabytes per second. Due to the proximity of the data carrying wires, interference was a major bottleneck to greater speeds. Each PATA channel can support two devices in a Master / Slave configuration.

2.1.29 PIO

Programmed Input Output mode of data transfer is the mode of data transfer that requires the CPU's intervention (in contrast to DMA and UDMA). Older optical drives still use this mode. There are many versions of PIO mode, with the latest being version 4, which offers a maximum speed of 16.7 Megabytes per second.

2.1.30 Platter

The surface on which data is stored in the form of magnetised and non-magnetised regions is usually a glass or aluminium disk coated with a magnetic substance. This disk is called a platter.

2.1.31 PMR

Perpendicular Magnetic Recording is a improved method for storing data on platters, allowing for greater areal density. Unlike the present method, also called Longitudinal Magnetic Recording, where the magnetised areas are laid out end to end, in PMR, the areas are arranged vertically, side by side, thus reducing the space they occupy.

2.1.32 Primary Partition

This refers to the partition whose details are included in the Master Partition table in the MBR. A maximum of four primary partitions can exist in a hard disk.

2.1.33 RAID

Redundant Array of Independent (mistakenly called Inexpensive sometimes) Disks is a scheme that allows multiple hard disks to be used to create a single unit with features better than what would be attained if they were not a unit. A "RAID controller" contains the circuitry to manage the disks as a single unit. There are different RAID schemes. The most popular ones are RAID 0, 1, 0+1 and 5.